Configuring User Management and Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) in a Zoho Creator Application

JobApplicationForm

Experiment 8

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1. AIM

To set up user management and role-based access control (RBAC) for the "Job Application Form" application in Zoho Creator, so that each type of user (Super Admin, Manager, Employee and portal Customer) receives a suitably limited role and permission profile, record visibility follows the reporting hierarchy and data sharing rules, and the application displays in the right language for each user, while no one is given more access than their role needs.

2. PROCEDURE

2.1 Defining Roles and the Role Hierarchy

1. Open the Job Application Form application in Zoho Creator and click **Settings** at the top.
2. Go to **Permissions > User Permissions** and open the **Roles** tab.
3. Select the **Manager** role and click **Edit**. Set **Reports to** as **CEO** and enter the description "reporting information".
4. Set **Share Data with Peers** to **Yes**, so that users holding the same role can view one another's job application records, and click **Save**.
5. Check the **Associated Users** table, which lists every user assigned to the role.

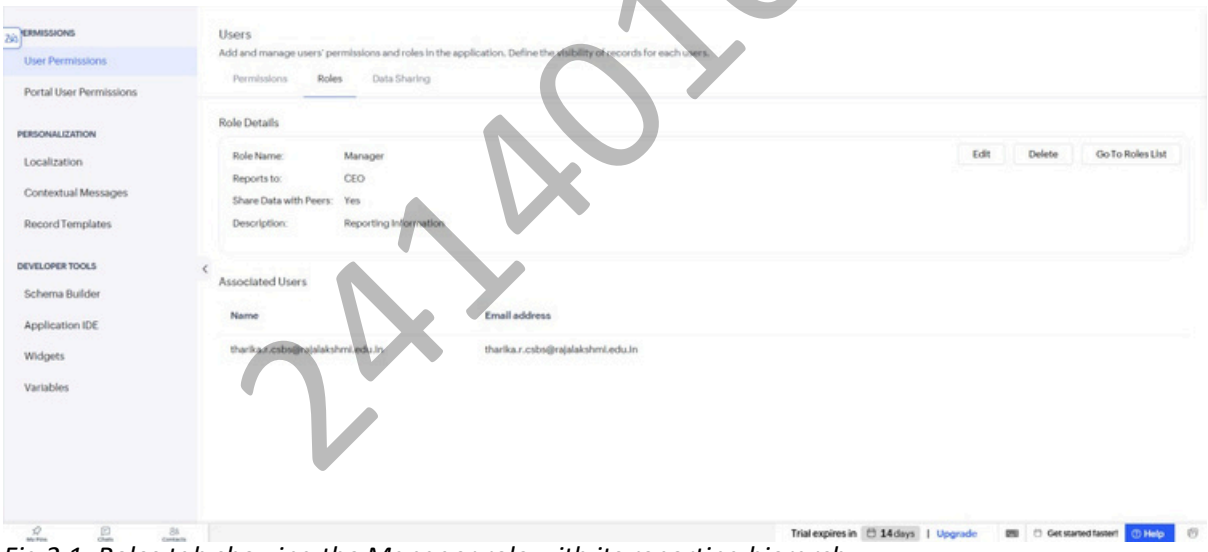


Fig 2.1: Roles tab showing the Manager role with its reporting hierarchy

Explanation: The "Reports to" setting creates the chain of command (Manager to CEO), which Zoho Creator uses to decide whose records a role can see above its own level. "Share Data with Peers" widens visibility sideways, so all managers can review the same applications. Together they set how far up and across the Manager role can see. The Associated Users table shows who holds the role; at this stage it is empty because no users have been assigned yet.

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2.2 Creating Permission Profiles for Each User Category

1. Go to **Settings > Permissions > User Permissions** and open the **Permissions** tab.
2. Click **Add Permission**.
3. Create a profile named **manager** with the description "supervising the event", and choose the forms, reports and pages it may access.
4. Click **Add Permission** again and create a profile named **sadhana**, giving it **read** permission on all components.
5. Confirm that the built-in **Write** profile (write permission on all components) is also listed.

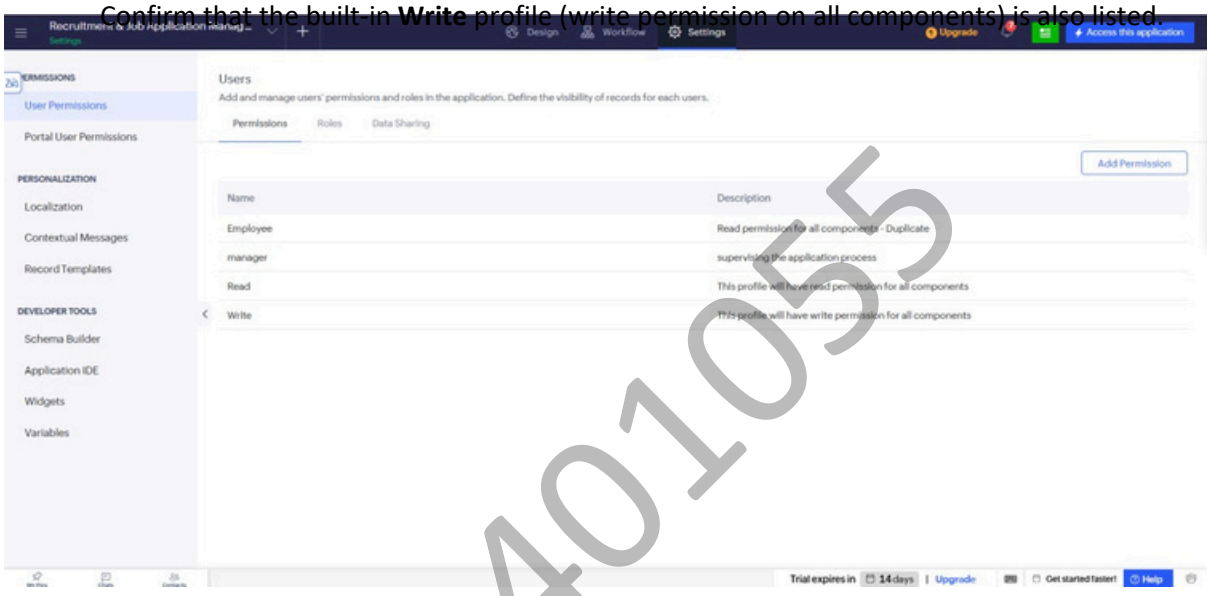


Fig 2.2: Permissions tab listing the permission profiles in the application

Explanation: A permission profile is a separately editable set of module-level and field-level access rights. The "manager" profile suits the person supervising the application process, "sadhana" gives read-only access to every component, and Write gives full write access. Using separate named profiles, rather than one shared profile, lets each user work only with the forms and reports relevant to their duties, which is the essence of role-based access control.

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2.3 Defining Data Sharing Rules

1. Open the **Data Sharing** tab and click **New Share Rule**.
2. For the first rule, enter the name **sadhana**, choose the form **Job Application**, set Shared From to the role **Manager**, Shared To to the role **Manager**, and Level of Access to **Read/Write**. Save it.
3. For the second rule, enter the name **revathy**, choose the form **Job Application**, set Shared From to the role **Employee**, Shared To to the user **SADHANA**, and Level of Access to **Read Only**. Save it.

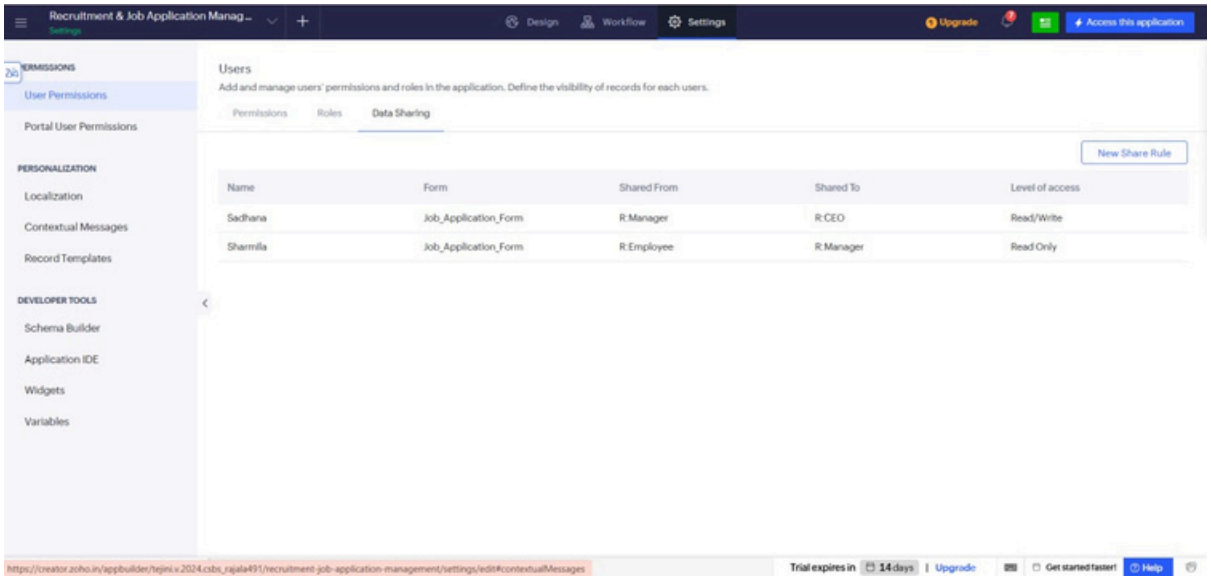


Fig 2.3: Data Sharing tab showing the share rules for the Job Application form

Explanation: Data sharing rules extend record visibility beyond what the role hierarchy gives by default. In the table, the prefix R: stands for a role and U: for an individual user. The first rule lets users in the Manager role view and edit each other's job applications. The second lets the user SADHANA see records submitted by the Employee role but only with Read Only access, so applications can be reviewed without being altered.

2.4 Setting Portal User Permissions

1. In the Settings menu, click **Portal User Permissions**.
2. Review the **Customer** profile, which is available by default as a portal-level permission.
3. Optionally, click **Add Permission** to create another portal profile.

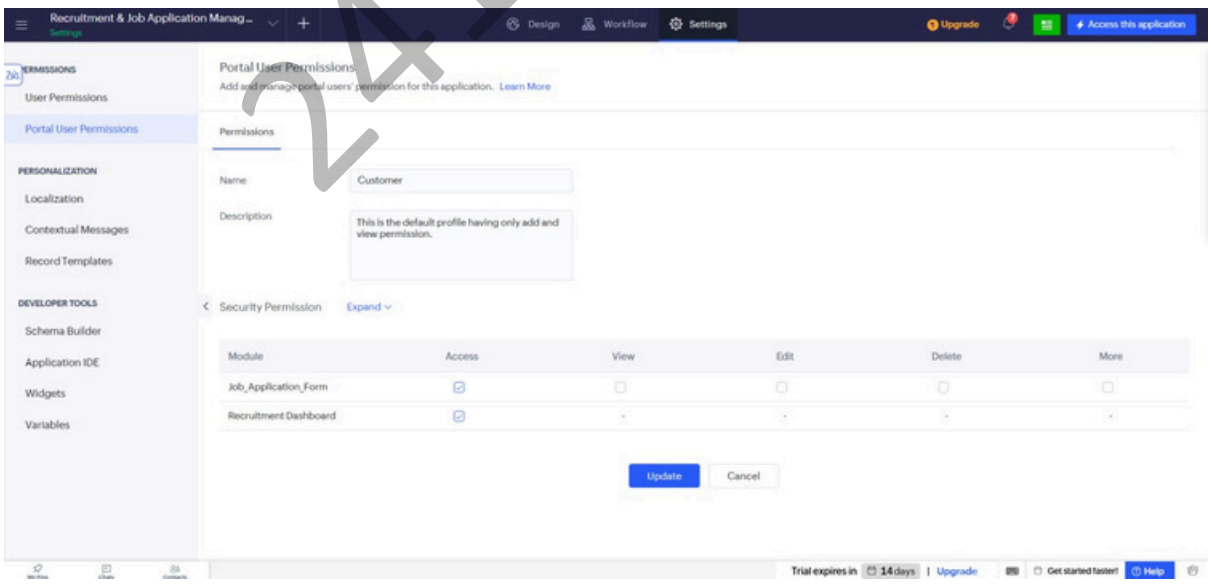


Fig 2.4: Portal User Permissions tab showing the profile available to portal users

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Explanation: Portal users are applicants who work with the application from outside the organisation, so they are managed separately from internal users. This allows applicant-facing accounts to receive a restricted set of permissions without exposing internal roles or developer settings. The Customer profile carries add and view permission only, so an applicant can submit and view a job application but cannot change or delete other records.

2.5 Configuring Application Localization

1. Go to **Settings > Personalization > Localization**.
2. Under "Which language should your app use?", select **User's browser language**. English remains the default language.
3. To support more languages, click **Add Language**.

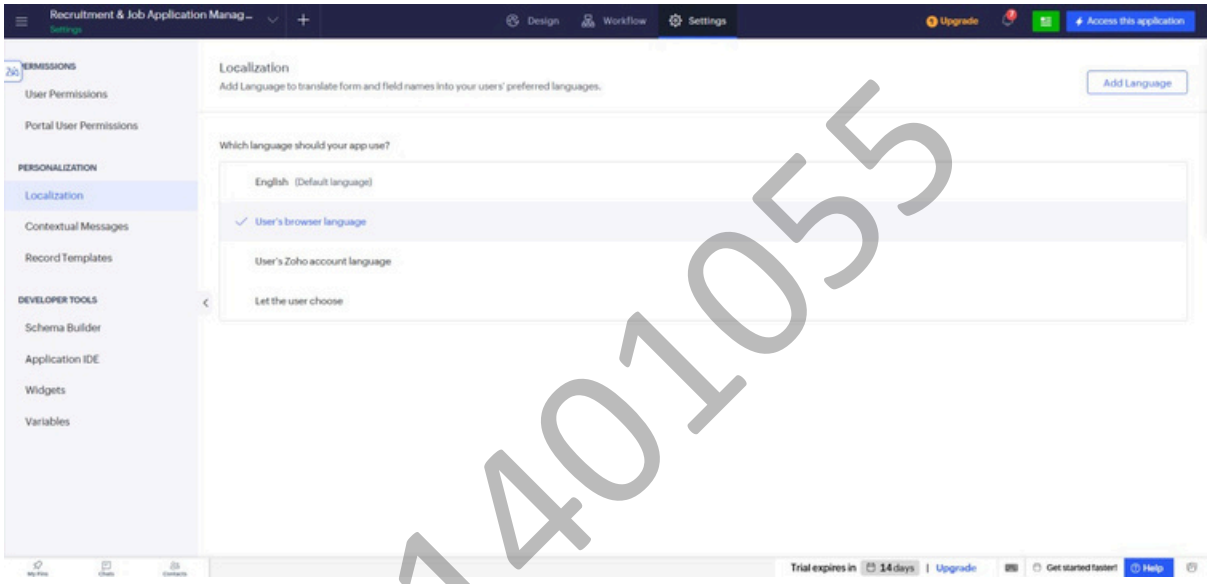


Fig 2.5: Localization settings for the application

Explanation: Localization complements RBAC by making the application usable for everyone. Once a user's permission profile decides what they can access, the localization setting decides the language in which form and field names appear: the browser language, the Zoho account language, or a language the user chooses. More languages can be added with the Add Language button.

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3. OUTPUT

After the roles, permission profiles, data sharing rules, portal permissions and localization settings were saved, the **All Users** page (Creator home > Users) listed the users with access to the application.

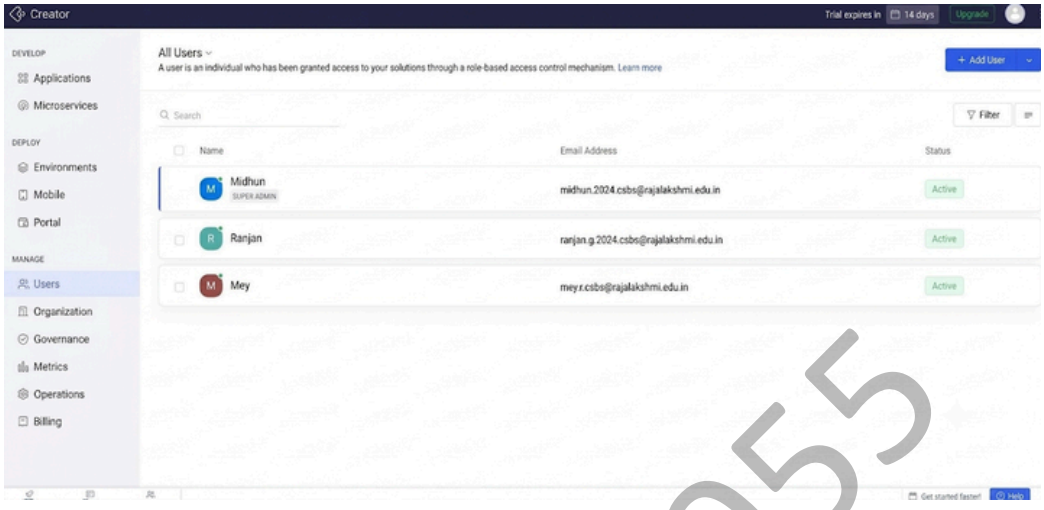


Fig 3: All Users page in Zoho Creator showing the users who have access

Explanation: The All Users page shows the Super Admin account together with the other added users: [list your user names here]. Each user has the status **Active**, which confirms they are set up in Zoho Creator and can sign in and work in the application within the access granted by their role and permission profile.

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4. RESULT

Role-based access control was configured successfully for the "Job Application Form" application in Zoho Creator. Separate roles and permission profiles were created for each category of user, a reporting hierarchy with peer data sharing was set for the Manager role, data sharing rules controlled record visibility between roles and users, portal users were limited to an add-and-view profile, and the interface was localized to the user's browser language. As a result, every user sees only the data and features that suit their role, and all listed users are Active.